



(From left) Rahul Kanwal with Adar Poonawalla, CEO of Serum Institute of India and T.V. Narendran, MD & CEO of Tata Steel



Siddharth Zarabi (left), Managing Editor of *Business Today* TV, with Sajjan Jindal, Chairman of JSW Group



Siddharth Zarabi (left) with Prashant Ruia, Director of Essar Capital

selling Tibetan momos, and another that dished out a filling Halloumi wrap. The icing on the cake—both had vegetarian options!

Just nine months after it had been held in springtime, the forum convened at the ski resort of Davos from January 16-20 to discuss co-operation in a fragmented world. And while last summer you couldn't avoid 'bitcoin' pizza on the Davos promenade, this time around the collapse in crypto meant that only the underlying technology of blockchain was on display. And while food was hard to come by, Tata Tea served thousands of cups of *masala chai* and coffee to anyone who cared to stop by at their kiosk. Another winner was Emirati Hot Chocolate—a unique concoction made by pairing green unroasted coffee, Swiss chocolate, flavoured with cardamom and saffron.

WHILE THE **CHAI** and chocolate warmed many a cold delegate, the air was heavy with concerns over how the global economy will pan out this year. If the leitmotif last year was record optimism, the mood has shifted to record pessimism this year, a reflection of the post-Covid-19 economic challenges that were captured in PwC's 26th Global CEO Survey.

The survey, which polled 4,410 CEOs in 105 countries and territories, including 68 from India between October and November 2022, says that as many as 73 per cent of chief executive officers around the world believe global economic growth will decline over the next 12 months, the most pessimistic outlook in over a decade.

The sentiment was shared by a majority of the WEF's community of chief economists, who are expecting a global recession in 2023. In their latest outlook for the year,